Ras Agez

Bi annual Newsletter of CoSAP

January to June 2025 issue No.21 (Vol.XI)

Message from the Secretariat

Dear Readers,

We are extremely pleased to share with you issue No. 21 "Ras Agez" newsletter covering January to June 2025. Please forward your comments, suggestions and remarks to us at cosap.doc@gmail.com.

Enjoy reading "Ras Agez"

Yosef Akalu
Director CoSAP

CoSAP strengthening Civil Society-Government partnership under the CSF+ program



CoSAP championed women's empowerment, CSO development, promotion of governance and inclusive development in Ethiopia through the EU-funded Civil Society Fund Plus (CSF+) Program. The organization continues to strengthen emerging and grassroots Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) by providing capacity building, fostering partnerships, and mobilizing resources to scale up achievements.

With financial support from the European Union Delegation to Ethiopia, through Welthungerhilfe/WHH, CoSAP is co-implementing the five-year Capacity Development Program for Local and Grassroots CSOs (2023–2028). Active in Afar, Amhara, Benishangul-Gumuz, Oromia and at the national level, the program aims to empower local civil society actors to participate in governance and inclusive development.

Its core priorities include strengthening organizational capacity, improving the enabling environment for CSOs, and channeling financial support to selected organizations to ensure that civil society remains a vital partner in Ethiopia's democratization process.

As part of this EU CSF+ Program, CoSAP organized high-level Forum held on May 8, 2025 in Hilton Addis Abeba. The Forum, which was hosted by the Office of the Prime Minister and presided by H.E Deputy Prime Minister Ato Adem Farah and Ato Amhed Hussien – President of the Ethiopian CSOs Council, established with the aim to create a national platform for Civil Society Organizations and Federal stakeholders to foster cooperation and collaboration.

At the close of the day long workshop, it was learned that the Platform is expected to roll out to regions with the same purpose of creating cooperation and collaboration spirits between regional governments and CSOs operating in that specific region.



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EU Delegation and Partners Strengthen Field Engagement with Local Subgrantees in Oromia

Delegates from the European Union Delegation (EUD) to Ethiopia, WHH, and CoSAP conducted field visits to sub grantee organizations in the Oromia region. These visits aimed to monitor project implementation, engage directly with beneficiaries and stakeholders, and strengthen coordination and mutual learning among all partners.

The team first met staffs of Hopeful Generation for Development (HGD) – a grantee implementing the project Promoting Culture of Peace through Youth, women and IDPs Engagement in Koye Feche Sub city, Sheger City Oromia.

The field level interaction provided valuable insights into the effectiveness of project activities and opportunities for enhancing sustainability by cultivating the culture of peaceful coexistence between Internally Displaced People (IDPs) and host community.

On the next round, the team visited projects of other sub grantees, namely O-YES Global Foundation, with a project entitled - Give a Way: Protecting Women's and Girls Right and Reduce prevalence of Early Marriage and Abduction.





The other organization was, Keabrak Charitable Organization (KCO) implementing the project on "Empowering Marginalized Women and Youth Workers in Dukem Eastern Industrial Zone: Towards Sustainable Livelihoods and Decent Work."

During these visits, the delegation held office-level discussions with respective staff, reviewed project implementation, and engaged with target beneficiaries, including community leaders, factory women, women groups and representatives from local offices (Women and Children Affairs, Labor and Social, local police and other similar bodies.)

These joint field visits reinforce the shared commitment of the EUD, WHH, and CoSAP to transparency, accountability, and sustainable development. By combining oversight with direct engagement with target beneficiaries, the partners vowed to continue to support sub grantees in delivering meaningful changes and empowering communities across Oromia.

Revitalization of SHGs in Jigjiga, Somalia Region

Women's economic and social participation in Jigjiga is being restored, with 22 SHGs (350 women) who had been disconnected by past insecurity now actively saving, lending, leading, and rebuilding their livelihoods through revitalized Self-Help Groups (SHGs). Their confidence, unity, and collective voice have re-emerged, signaling a renewed women-led movement in the Somali Region.

The revitalized SHGs are once again functioning as safe and reliable spaces for savings, mutual support, and local problem-solving. Women have regained the structures and motivation needed to restart income-generating activities and reclaim their leadership roles in their communities. At the system level, the Women and Children Affairs Bureau is playing an active role in supervising and coaching the groups, helping ensure sustainability and stronger local ownership.



These results were made possible through coordinated efforts including reconnecting dormant groups, refreshing SHG governance and financial practices, mentoring district social workers, and providing continuous follow-up support. Tearfund Ireland's contribution, combined with CoSAP's technical guidance and the commitment of the Women and Children Affairs Bureau, has created the right conditions for women in Jigjiga to rebuild their livelihoods and strengthen their economic resilience.





partial views of the workshops to revitalize the groups

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Building CSO's & People Institution's for Sustainable Impact

CoSAP has spent the past months delivering a coordinated series of trainings, dialogues, and learning exchanges designed to strengthen the capacity, leadership, and accountability of grassroots Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) and People's Institutions (PIs) across multiple regions. These efforts are building a more connected and capable network of community structures that can lead local development and drive sustainable change.

The initiative began in Addis Ababa with hands-on database management sessions that helped PIs improve data quality, digital record-keeping, and accurate reporting. This was followed by intensive engagements in Adama focused on the Self Help Group Approach (SHGA), covering SHG formation, sustainability principles, leadership roles within People's Institutions, and the value of peer learning. Partners enriched the discussions with real-life experiences in savings culture, loan management, and digital engagement, strengthening practical understanding of the SHG model.

CoSAP's work in Oromia centered on enhancing leadership and team management for grassroots CSOs, strengthening governance, teamwork, and community-centered leadership. A subsequent training in Addis Ababa focused on financial and grant management petty cash handling, procurement, compliance, and asset management helping partners build transparent and accountable systems. Another specialized session on Advocacy, Gender, and Economic Inclusion deepened participants' understanding of human rights, gender equality, inclusive livelihood pathways, and practical advocacy tools for advancing community development.



To reinforce community data systems, CoSAP conducted an interactive SHG Data Management session in Batu, engaging SHG chairwomen, record-keepers, volunteers, and local partners to explore digital tools and sustainable reporting practices. In collaboration with regional partners, CoSAP also organized constituency dialogue workshops in Bishoftu and Holeta under the theme "Strengthening People's Institutions through Constituency Dialogue and Database Development." These events brought together SHGs, Cluster Level Associations (CLAs), the Timret Lelewut Federation (TLT), government stakeholders, and young women leaders to share experiences, showcase model SHGs, and identify pathways for stronger, more coordinated community solutions.

Together, these initiatives demonstrate CoSAP's ongoing commitment to equipping community institutions with the knowledge, systems, and confidence they need to lead sustainable, people-driven development across Ethiopia.

CEHRO Strengthens Advocacy Capacity of SHG Federations

Women leaders from Self-Help Group (SHG) Federations across Ethiopia are strengthening their voice and influence in community and national spaces. The two-day leadership and advocacy workshop facilitated by the Consortium of Ethiopian Human Rights Organizations (CEHRO) resulted in increased confidence, stronger understanding of rights, and improved capacity among federation leaders to engage in policy dialogues, confront gender-based violence, and advocate for women's and children's rights. Participants left with clearer action plans and stronger networks, reinforcing the growing impact of SHG Federations as community change agents.

Held on March 24–25, 2025, in Addis Ababa, the workshop equipped grassroots women leaders with practical skills in lobbying, human and child rights, policy engagement, and networking. Participants reflected on their achievements including improved savings and financial management, growing participation in local governance, and stronger advocacy against harmful practices while candidly identifying challenges such as economic hardship, displacement, gaps in legal recognition outside Oromia, and limited access to training and digital financial services.

CEHRO experts guided participants through human rights principles, advocacy techniques, and partner-mapping strategies using group discussions, role-plays, and scenario analysis. These interactive methods helped leaders practice real-life lobbying, explore opportunities for collaboration, and design follow-up actions for connecting with national platforms such as Network of Ethiopian Women Associations (NEWA), Ethiopian Women Lawyers Association (EWLA) and CEHRO itself

The workshop reaffirmed CoSAP's commitment to strengthening SHG Federations as influential actors in community development. By building women's leadership and advocacy capacity, the initiative continues to support a more rights-aware, inclusive, and empowered grassroots movement across Ethiopia.



SHG Training Empowers Women in Bedele Town

Women in Bedele are taking stronger steps toward economic independence and collective resilience, following a five-day training that boosted their confidence, skills, and readiness to form and manage Self-Help Groups (SHGs). Participants left the sessions with a clear understanding of how SHGs operate, renewed motivation to organize within their communities, and the capacity to begin savings, lending, and small-business planning in a structured and sustainable way.

Delivered by the Bedele Town Community of Practice (BT-CoP) from May 12–16, 2025, the training brought together women who are either part of emerging SHGs or preparing to form new groups. Over the week, they explored the core principles and values of the SHG approach, practiced the steps for establishing strong groups, and strengthened their skills in transparent record-keeping, leadership, internal lending, and basic enterprise development.

The sessions also emphasized confidence-building, peer learning, and the power of collective effort in improving household stability. By the end of the training, participants demonstrated deeper understanding of self-managed group systems and expressed readiness to apply these tools within their communitiesmarking a meaningful step toward expanding and strengthening the SHG movement in Bedele Town.



የ 2018 ዓ.ም ዓለም አቀፍ የሴቶች ቀን በድምቀት ተከበረ

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በተለይ የሴቶችን አስተዋፅዖ እውቅና ለመስጠት እና የሥርዓተ-ፆታ እኩልነትን ግንዛቤ ለማሳደግ በመላው አገሪቱ ሰፊ እንቅስቃሴ ተደርጎ የተለያዩ የማህበረሰብ ክፍሎች ስራዎችን፣ ተሞክሮዎች እንዲሁም የበጎ አድራጎት እንቅስቃሴዎችን በማድረግ ክብረ በዓሉ የበለጠ እንዲደምቅ ሆኖ ትጠናቃል።

በተለያዩ ከተሞች የሚንቀሳቀሱት የራስ አገዝ ተቃማት አባሎቻቸውን እና የተለያዩ ባለድርሻ አካላትን በማስተባበር ሴቶችን በውሳኔ አሰጣጥ፣ እድሎችን እና ሀብቶችን ተደራሽነት እና በቤት ውስጥም ሆነ በህብረተሰብ ውስጥ ያላቸውን ሚና የሚያጎሉ ዝግጅቶችን በማድረግ አክብረዋል። ከተለያዩ ተቋማት የተውጣጡ ተሳታፊዎች በሥርዓተ-ፆታ ላይ የተመሰረተ ጥቃትን በተመለከተ ግንዛቤን ለማሳደግ እና የትብብር ጥረቶችን ለማድረግ ቃል የገቡበት የውይይት መድረኮች እና እንቅስቃሴዎች ተደርገዋል።

በተጨማሪም ከየአከባቢው የመንግስት ቢሮዎች ጋር በመተባበር የስፖርት ውድድሮች፤ ሰፋፊ የፓናል ውይይቶች እና የማህበረሰብ ንቅናቄ ዝግጅቶች መደረጋቸው ለበዓሉ ትልቅ ድምቀት ሰጥተው አልፍዋል። በዚህም የሴቶችን ኢኮኖሚያዊ አቅም ማጎልበት፣ መብቶች እና በህብረተሰቡ ውስጥ ያሉ ያላችውን ተሳትፎ የሚጠናከርበት ጉዳይ ላይ ያተኮሩ ቁልፍ መልዕክቶች ተላልፈዋል። በአገር አቀፍ ደረጃ ለሴቶች እና ልጃገረዶች በራስ መተማመንን እና እድሎችን ለማጎልበት ሀላፊንት ያለባቸው አካላት ያላቸውን ቁርጠኝነት ገልጸዋል።

ይህን አለም አቀፍ ብሎም በአገር አቅፍ ደረጃ በየዓመቱ የሚከበረውን በዓል ምክንያት በማድረግ በአዲስ አበባ፣ አዳማ፣ ቢሾፍቱ፣ ቡልቡላ፣ ድሬደዋ፣ ሐዋሳ፣ ወላይታ ሶዶ፣ ፍቼ፣ ደብረብርሃን፣ ጅማ የሚገኙ የራስ አገዝ ቡድን ጥምረቶች ከአባል የራስ አገዝ ሴቶች፣ ከህብረቶች ያሰባሰቡትን ድጋፍ የኮሳፕ ሠራተኞችም ያደረጉትን አስተዋጽዖ በማከል በአጠቃላይ ብር100,000.00 (አንድ መቶ ሺ ብር) የገንዘብ ድጋፍ ለመቄዶንያ የአረጋውያን የአእምሮ ህሙማን መርጃ ማዕከል በሰይፉ ፋንታሁን ፕሮግራም ላይ በመገኘት አበርክተዋል።



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Ras Agez" meaning "Self Help"

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